

low user base as it requires an invitation to join. Communities are created under thirty or so general category headings (similar to those found at the top level of the Open Directory Project) and contain usual message forums and events listings. orkut has been criticized for its poor privacy policy, which has recently been revised.

Ryze (www.ryze.com)

Ryze was originally an online business networking site, but members have also been using the site to communicate with other members for dating and other social networking purposes through the use of photos in each member's profile. It is a free service where people can join and become members of various different networks. However, members can also subscribe to gold membership at \$9.95 a month which is a paid service that enables members to perform advanced searches. The Ryze site also organizes events for people offline. Ryze profiles contain guest books for other members to leave messages or e-mails for other users. It also lists a section for classifieds which members can post to.

Spoke (www.spoke.com)

Spoke is a professional networking site that helps people to build their business network connections online. It is a modern day approach to the traditional networking process in business. It helps to build a private and secure business network. The value of the network increases as more professional members are added. Spoke uses e-mail details and other information provided by its members in their user profiles to strengthen their relationships. Spoke helps its members to increase their prospects for opportunities, and in helping to find a job it also enables members to obtain referrals through people they already know.

Tickle (www.tickle.com)

Tickle is a social networking site used for social activities such as dating and socializing. It makes use of a number of personality tests for matchmaking online. Tickle states that they apply science to help their members to build relationships online, providing a psychological analysis of each member's personalities and other insights